MIL-O-43901A
31 December 1986
SUPERSEDING
MIL-O-43901
12 August 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ONIONS, DEHYDRATED, COMPRESSED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers dehydrated, compressed onions for use by the Department of Defense as an item of general issue

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Documents. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8915

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

TT-C-495 - Coatings, Exterior, for Tinned Food Cans
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping. Fiberboard
PPP-C-29 - Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing of

MILITARY

MIL-L-1497 - Labeling of Metal Cans for Subsistence Items
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage, General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents. The following other Government documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Director, Market Research and Development Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

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ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St Paul, MN 55121.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, P.O. Box 2109, Novato, CA 94947.)

AMERICAN DRY MILK INSTITUTE, INC.

Standards for Grades of Dry Milks, Including Methods of Analysis, Bulletin 916

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dry Milk Institute, Inc., 130 North Franklin Street, Chicago, IL 60606.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314.)

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UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1100, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence Nothing in this document, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Bid sample approval. Twelve (unless otherwise specified - see 6.1) cans of at least 6 avoirdupois ounces each, representative of the product which the bidder proposes to furnish, shall be submitted to the contracting officer. One or more of the samples will be tested to determine whether the product has the desired subjective quality characteristics as specified in 3.4. The remaining samples shall be used as a reference standard for determining compliance of deliveries with subjective quality requirements Bid samples submitted by the bidder shall be held at a temperature of 40°F or lower until used. Additional samples may be withdrawn from accepted lots of materials for use as reference standards as necessary. The contracting officer's approval of the bid samples does not relieve the bidder from complying with all other requirements of the document not stipulated above

3 2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors

3.2.1 Onions, dehydrated. The dehydrated onions shall be prepared from pungent, high solids white onions with not less than 10 percent solids content and shall be fancy grade chopped white onions of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onions and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic products.

3 2.2 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3 3 Preparation and processing Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

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3 3.1 Conditioning. The dehydrated onions shall be conditioned by adding moisture sufficient to make them pliable so that they will not be crushed or ground under high pressure. (NOTE: Satisfactory conditioned onions have been produced by adding moisture, either by applying wet live steam for approximately 5 minutes or spraying with water, to increase the weight by 8 to 14 percent and placing the sprayed onions in a closed container and then heating, approximately 10 minutes at 150°F, in order to equilibrate the moisture in the onions.)

3.3.2 Compression. The conditioned onions shall be placed in a 3-12/16 ± 1/8 inch diameter mold and compressed into discs by applying 200 to 400 pounds per square inch pressure for a dwell time of 5 to 30 seconds depending upon the variety and maturity of the onions. (Note: It has been found that a disc of approximately 1/2 inch in thickness gives good results. Discs thicker than 1/2 inch tend to relax too much and make it difficult to fill 19.0 ounces of product into the can).

3.3.3 Redrying. The compressed onions shall be redried within a minimum of time so that the finished product complies with 3.4.

3.4 Finished product requirements.

3.4.1 Compressed product. The compressed dehydrated product shall be in the form of discs 3-12/16 inches ± 1/8 inch in diameter, and 1/2 inch in thickness, ± 1/16 inch. Disc thickness may vary slightly depending on type of onions, pressure, and dwell time used. The compressed dehydrated product shall be free from hay-like, scorched, rancid, musty, or other objectionable odors; shall not exceed 4 0 percent, by weight, of moisture; and shall possess a bright uniform color typical of dehydrated onions of similar variety and with a maximum optical density of 0.090. No individual can shall contain less than 19.0 ounces of product.

3.4.2 Rehydrated product. The rehydrated product shall possess the color, odor, pungent flavor, and appearance typical of fresh onions and a fleshy texture which is tender but not mushy. The compressed onions shall rehydrate to approximately their original cut form when each 1.0 part of compressed onion is added to 6.25 parts of 70° to 90°F water, by weight, and allowed to soak for 1 hour.

3.4.3 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved bid sample in palatability and overall appearance.

3.5 Plant qualification. The product shall be prepared, processed, and packaged under sanitary conditions in accordance with good manufacturing practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the sanitary requirements of the applicable government inspection agency.

3.6 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4 3 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4 3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.3 1.1 Ingredient and component examination Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4 3.1.2 Unfilled can inspection. Conformance of unfilled cans to the requirements specified in 5.1 1 shall be determined by examination of certificates of conformance or of other valid documents. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the can lot or of any involved product.

4.3.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, can interior coating, filling, sealing, and packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

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4.3 3 Net weight inspection. The cans of product shall be examined for net weight. If the net weight of any individual can is less than 19 0 ounces, the lot shall be rejected The lot size shall be expressed in units of cans The sample unit shall be one can of product. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.3.4 Product inspection. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in cans The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed can of product The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5 for major defects and 6.5 for minor defects.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
		Dehydrated product
101		Haylike, scorched, rancid, musty or other objectionable odor.
	201	Diameter of product disc not as specified.
		Rehydrated product 3/
102		Onions do not rehydrate to a form similar to their original cut form.
103		Flavor, color, and appearance not as specified.
104		Texture is mushy or tough.

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved bid sample in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent.)

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3/ Examine approximately 1 pound of rehydrated onion from each sample unit The compressed dehydrated product shall be rehydrated by adding 6 25 parts of 70° to 90°F water to 1 0 part of onions, by weight, stirring to break apart, and allowing to stand for 1 hour.

4.3 5 Product testing

4.3 5.1 Moisture content and optical density testing. The finished product shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1 and 4.4.2 for conformance to the moisture and optical density requirements in 3 4 1. The sample for testing shall be a 4-pound composite, derived from the number of cans indicated by inspection level S-2. The lot size shall be expressed in cans. Results for moisture shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent A test failure for either moisture content or optical density shall be cause for rejection of the lot

4.3.5.2 Oxygen in headspace testing. The filled and sealed cans shall be tested as specified in 4 4 3 for conformance to the oxygen in headspace requirement in 5.1.1. The lot size shall be expressed in cans. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed can The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.3.6 Can condition examination. Examination of filled and sealed cans shall be in accordance with U S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers, except that inspection for labeling shall be in accordance with MIL-L-1497 (see 5.4).

4.3.7 Leakage and vacuum (when applicable) examination. Examination for leakage and vacuum shall be in accordance with PPP-C-29 (see 5.1.1).

4.3 8 Shipping container examination Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Reinforced with other than nonmetallic strapping or tape.
Dimensions of pads not as specified
Interior packing with fiberboard liner or pads not as specified.

Minor. Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Arrangement or number of cans not as specified.

Level C shipping containers shall be examined only for the marking, arrangement, and number of cans defects specified above and for the closure method specified in 5.2.3.

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4.3.9 Unit load inspection Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

4.4 Methods of inspection.

4.4.1 Moisture content test. Prepare a clean, dry Waring blender or similar mill by grinding a sample and discarding it. Grind approximately 100 grams of a well mixed sample in the prepared blender. Sieve the ground material through a U.S. Standard No. 20 sieve and collect that portion which passes through in a clean, dry, tightly closed container. Weigh two samples, approximately 3.0 grams each of the sieved material, into tared, dry, aluminum weighing dishes (approximately 2 or 2-1/2 inches in diameter and 3/4 inch in depth) with tight-fitting covers. Place the dishes with cocked lids in a vacuum oven and dry for 6 hours at 70°C under a pressure of not more than 100 mm mercury During drying, admit to the oven a slow current of air (approximately two bubbles per second) dried by passing through concentrated sulfuric acid. Remove the dishes and allow them to cool in a desiccator before weighing. Calculate the percent of moisture in the original samples.

4.4.2 Optical density test. Optical density shall be determined in accordance with Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

4.4.3 Oxygen content test. Oxygen content of headspace gas shall be determined in accordance with American Dry Milk Institute Inc., publication, Bulletin 916, Standards for Grades of Dry Milks; Including Methods of Analysis: Determination of Oxygen. The result of each determination shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent for each can. Alternatively, the headspace oxygen content may be determined by an Instrumentation Laboratories Oxygen Analyzer or equivalent instrument. Test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent for each can. The lot shall be rejected if any of the cans exceeds 2.0 percent oxygen. When referee testing is necessary, the American Dry Milk Institute method shall be followed.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. The product shall be preserved in accordance with level A or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. A net weight of 19.0 ounces of product shall be unit packed into an open-top style, round metal can, size 401 by 411, with a soldered or welded side seam and compound-lined double-seamed ends. The can shall be made throughout from not less than 0.25 pound per base box electrolytic tin plate. The base plate of the can shall be of sufficient temper to protect the product

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during shipment and storage The entire inside area of the can shall be coated The interior can coating shall not peel or blister when in contact with the product. The can shall be coated overall on the outside with a coating conforming to type I, or when specified (see 6 1) type III of TT-C-495 The can shall be sealed under an atmosphere of nitrogen so that the oxygen content of the gases in the filled and sealed container shall not exceed 2.0 percent when tested in accordance with 4.3.5 2. The nitrogen packed cans shall be hermetically sealed and shall not show leakage when examined in accordance with 4.3.7. Alternatively, the cans may be hermetically sealed under a vacuum of not less than 27 inches of mercury when examined in accordance with procedures in PPP-C-29 When cans are closed under vacuum, the oxygen requirement is not applicable.

5 1 2 Level C. The product shall be preserved as specified in 5.1.1, except that cans with or without exterior commercial coating will be acceptable. Alternatively, cans may be made from 0.20 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate, provided the cans have an exterior commercial coating.

5.2 Packing. Twenty-four cans, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed on end four in length, three in width, and two in depth within a snug-fitting shipping container in accordance with level A, B, or C as specified (see 6 1).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Twenty-four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard box, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC, grade V2s, of PPP-B-636. The tiered cans shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad made of the same material as the box. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class load specified (see 6.1). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Twenty-four cans of product, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed as specified in 5.2 1 except the box shall be constructed of grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard.

5.2.3 Level C packing. The shipping container shall be in accordance with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable, except the closure of the fiberboard boxes shall be in accordance with Method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.3 Unit loading. When specified (see 6.1), the product packed as specified in 5.2.2 and 5.2.3, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

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5.4 Labeling and marking.

5 4.1 Cans Cans shall be labeled in accordance with MIL-L-1497 and shall include the following information.

Onions, Dehydrated, Compressed
Net Weight 19.0 oz.
Name and address of supplier
Date packaged
GAS PACKAGED (if applicable)

Directions for Use

Onions, dehydrated, compressed	19.0 oz.
Water, (70° to 90°F)	3.5 qts.

1 Add contents of can to water
2. Stir occasionally to break apart.
3. Allow to rehydrate for 60 or more minutes.

Yield: Four quarts of raw onions.

NOTE: 1. One disc may be prepared by adding it to 1 pint of water at room temperature (70° to 90°F) and allowing it to rehydrate for 30 minutes or more. One disc (1/2 inch) yields 2 cups of chopped onions.

2. One pound of dehydrated compressed onions is equivalent to 10 pounds of unpeeled fresh onions.

5.4.2 Shipping containers. In addition to any special marking required by the contract, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.3 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When other than 12 cans of bid sample is required (see 3.1)
c. Level of preservation and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. When type III exterior coating of cans is desired (see 5.1.1).
e. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.2.1 and 5.3).

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6.2 Appropriate level of pack Based on the conditions known or expected to be encountered during shipment, handling, and storage of the specific item being procured, the procuring activity should select the appropriate level of pack in accordance with the criteria established in AR 700-15/NAVSUPINST 4030 28/AFR 71-6/MCO 4030 33A/DLAR 4145.7

6.3 Overseas packing. Packing specified in 5.2 2 is intended for transfer at sea operations or specific overseas operations.

6 4 Level C. Packing specified in 5 2.3 is intended for direct shipment from the supplier to the first consuming activity within CONUS for immediate consumption.

6 5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Onions
Dehydrated
Compressed
Disc form

6.6 Changes from previous issue Asterisks (or vertical lines) are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians·

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8915-0799

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-O-43901A	Onions, Dehydrated, Compressed

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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